



Defending the South

South Vietnamese troops and policemen return fire from behind a wall as part of a counterattack against Viet Cong forces in Saigon. With the bulk of US forces deployed elsewhere, ARVN troops were key in repelling the communist attack.

The real winner

Although the Tet Offensive was a massive military defeat for the NVA and the Viet Cong, it also proved a major strategic victory for North Vietnam because of its psychological impact on the American public, media, and politicians. The overall attack, especially the communists' penetration of the US Embassy compound in Saigon, caused a media firestorm and a profound political backlash in America.